



ASUS EeePC

Tiny But Functional

After some delays the EeePC was officially launched here in India.

The EeePC is a laptop with a 7-inch screen that's powered by a mobile Intel Celeron 900 MHz processor, 512 MB of memory, Xandros—a Linux distribution—as the OS. The interface has been customised with the most essential applica-

tions neatly sorted into categories. This makes the EeePC extremely easy to use, even for people who have never used a computer before.

The keyboard layout is compact and the keys and touchpad are smaller than conventional laptops. Those used to normal laptops and desktops will find the ASUS EeePC slightly painful to

use. The build quality of the keyboard and the screen hinge is a lot better than we expected. The inbuilt WiFi (802.11b/g) and 10/100Mbps LAN port take care of connectivity.

So what's not to like? There's no optical drive, so installing applications is going to be a bit of a problem. You can't upgrade the inbuilt memory either. As for hard drives, we got the 4 GB version, but 2, 8 and 16 GB versions are available as well. Windows versions of the EeePC will be launched soon. The laptop is silent, but heats up after a while.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

ASUS might promote the EeePC as a children's PC, something like the OLPC, but we're thinking ultra-portable! Since regular laptops with 80 GB drives and standard screens are available for around Rs 22,000, and ultra compact laptops cost over Rs 75,000, the ASUS EeePC might fill a void here. At Rs 18,000, it's a steal for something that weighs under a kg—as long as you don't plan on playing games or watching HD movies on it.

Specifications

Intel Celeron-M 900MHz, 512MB DDR2, 4GB flash drive, 7-inch screen (800x480), 10/100Mbps Ethernet, 802.11b/g WLAN,

Contact: ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 022-67668800
E-mail: media_india@asus.com
Web site: <http://in.asus.com/>
Price: Rs 18,000



eSys Sub 10K Fighter PC

One PC Per Child Anyone?

The eSys Sub 10K Fighter PC is a minimal desktop PC that is aimed at people with the most basic of needs. The configuration of the PC isn't hot—no dual-core processors or even an entry level graphics card on it. The processor is a 939-pin AMD Sempron 3000+ on a VIA K8M800-based motherboard that has everything integrated.

The performance is as low as we expected—3DMark 2005 churned out a score of 1618—pathetic. Even a basic PCI-E graphics card would have helped—and the motherboard only has an AGP slot for expansion. HD (1080p) videos were unwatchable, and the lack of a dual-core processor means that

video encoding performance also takes a big hit—almost double the time of what an entry level dual core processor would take.

The cabinet is fairly small, but sturdy. Still, it's quite obvious that quality wasn't the highest priority when this PC was built. If looks aren't important to you, you will be fine with the cabinet, but the monitor will still embarrass you.

One could use the "what do you expect

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for that price" analogy, but the bottom line is that it could use a little design love.

The low price tag of Rs 9,990 makes everything an acceptable compromise, especially for those who do nothing but chat, e-mail and surf all day, or for schools and educational institutions.

Specifications

AMD Sempron 3000+, 512MB DDR400 RAM, Onboard VIA S3G Unichrome Pro IGP, 120GB Seagate Baracuda HDD, 15" CRT monitor.

Contact: Esys Information Technologies Ltd
Phone: +91-9313890776
E-mail: ankurjain@esysmail.com
Web site: www.esys.in
Price: Rs 9,990



LG KU990 Viewty

LG Touch?

Every company has a touchscreen operated phone and the KU990 is a 3-inch, 3G touch screen phone from LG. The metal plate and the glossy front with chrome borders give the phone a stylish-yet-sturdy look.

You will soon realise that the main menu interface looks and feels a lot like the HTC / iPod Touch and iPhone. You can use either a finger or stylus to slide through menus. There's no place to store the stylus on the phone though.

There aren't too many buttons on the phone, primarily because of its touch screen functionality. There is a jog dial on the back of the phone around the camera lens which can be used to

scroll through items or change sound volumes. However, this is inconvenient to use, and scrolling through menus using it is especially difficult. Scrolling using the touch-screen is a little cumbersome as well—those with shaky hands might accidentally launch an application off and on. There's a full keyboard on the touch-screen, and it works well with either your fingers or the stylus—our only complaint is the awkwardly-placed spacebar.

RATINGS	
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Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

There is a 5 MP camera with a flash, and a standard VGA camera for video calls. The 100 MB internal memory is paltry, but can be supported by the Micro SD card slot. The earpiece is perfect, but the microphone quality is strictly average—expect some minor crackling. The speakerphone is fine, but gives out a high shrieking sound at times. The earphones that are bundled with the phone... err... just get the job done.

Great looks, a fun UI and ease of use make this a good phone. The touch-screen could have been better, and the jog dial is just bad. At a price of Rs 21,900, it's a good style statement.



Specifications

3-inch screen (240x400), 5 MP Camera, 100 MB memory, MicroSD slot, Dimensions: 103.5 x 54.4 x 14.8 mm, GPRS, EDGE, 3G HSDPA, Bluetooth.

Contact: LGEIL Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 91-120-2560900
E-mail: viveksingh@lgindia.com
Web site: www.lgindia.com
Price: Rs 21,900

Samsung NV8

NV10's Little Brother Is Here

The Samsung NV8 is the younger sibling of the NV10 that we tested in October 2007. This is an 8 MP camera with 3x optical zoom, and looks and feels exactly like the NV10.

The interface on the camera is simple to use, and is controlled by the touch sensitive buttons on either side of the screen. They're easy to use, but take a little getting used to. The camera has a rough matte finish with a 2.5-inch screen.

Image quality is also very similar to the NV10. The clarity and crispness is there, and higher ISO levels give out a little grain in the image. The colours aren't very vibrant, and have a washed look to them—especially in outdoor lighting.

Indoor shooting is a different story altogether, and the NV8 seems to be

better indoors than outdoors. You can get macro shots from up to 4 cm away with good results. The video quality is good, and the same macro feature works for videos as well. Video resolutions are 640x480 and 320x240, and are saved as AVIs using MPEG4 codecs. The audio bitrate is 64 kbps, though the quality is nothing special.

Face detection and image stabilisation are present as features, but image stabilization only kick in when you turn the mode knob to ASR (Advanced Shake Reduction). If you use ASR

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for videos, a small area of the capture is cropped.

This camera is pretty much the NV10 with a lower MP rating. This average performing camera is priced at Rs 13,990, and to be frank, there are better cameras available in the same price range.

Specifications

8.1 Megapixel (3264 x

2448px), 2.5" screen, ISO Rating: 100–3200, Shutter speed range: 1/1500th sec–15secs, Dimensions: 96.5 x 60 x 18.6mm, Weight: 151.7gm.

Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: jitender.c@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com/in
Price: Rs 13,990